

MUSCLES OF THE BODY

THE MUSCLES ARE RESPONSIBLE FOR MOVEMENT. THEY ACHIEVE THIS BY CONTRACTING AND PULLING ON THE BONES TO WHICH THEY ARE ATTACHED.

The typical male body contains approximately 640 muscles, which compose around two-fifths of its total weight. The same number in a female body make up a slightly smaller proportion. A typical muscle spans a joint and tapers at each end into a fibrous tendon anchored to a bone. Some muscles divide to attach to different bones. Superficial muscles, those located just beneath the skin, are pictured here on the left side of a male body. On the right side of this body are the deeper layers – the intermediate and deep muscles.

